Over 2.5 goals: V4 report

Mon 09 Nov 2026 to Fri 13 Nov 2026 (english). All times UK.

Executive summary

7 fixtures analysed: High 1, Medium 1, Weak 1, rejected 4. Selected fixtures with both attacks scoring 2+ in 3 of 5 or better: 1.

Selection engine: the validated model (V4 lock; V4.1 changes in config/model_config.json). Benchmark, season 2026-27 to 2026-11-08 (1824 finished fixtures, Rob's 14 leagues, clean out of sample): 3+ goals in High 84 of 119, Medium 145 of 235, trump card 3 of 4, rejected 812 of 1466. Band counts, not the chance of any one fixture. Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ counts are shown on every card as supporting evidence; both attacks at 3 of 5+ adds about three points inside the bands and is highlighted, not required.

Selected fixtures ranked by model score (up to 20)

#	Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	Home sc2+ / let2+	Away sc2+ / let2+	Both 3/5+	BTTS	Confidence	Division	Main risk (Over 2.5 = Yes for every row)
1	Tue 10 Nov 19:45	National League South	Salisbury v Braintree	4/5 · 0/5	1/5 · 3/5		NO (Med)	High	cold	Braintree let in 2+ in 3 of 5 but scored 2+ only 1 of 5: leaky, not scoring
2	Mon 09 Nov 19:30	FA Cup	Plymouth Parkway v Berkhamsted	3/5 · 2/5	2/5 · 3/5		YES (Hig)	Medium	warm	No major warning in the last five
3	Mon 09 Nov 19:45	National League South	Chelmsford City v Ebbsfleet United	3/5 · 2/5	3/5 · 1/5	yes	NO (Med)	Weak	cold	Away side kept 3/5 clean sheets

Grouped shortlist (date, competition, confidence, model score)

Mon 09 Nov · FA Cup

Medium	Plymouth Parkway v Berkhamsted 19:30	H scored 2+ 3/5 · H let in 2+ 2/5 · A scored 2+ 2/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5	BTTS YES (High)

Mon 09 Nov · National League South

Weak	Chelmsford City v Ebbsfleet United 19:45	H scored 2+ 3/5 · H let in 2+ 2/5 · A scored 2+ 3/5 · A let in 2+ 1/5 · both 3/5+	BTTS NO (Medium)

Tue 10 Nov · National League South

High	Salisbury v Braintree 19:45	H scored 2+ 4/5 · H let in 2+ 0/5 · A scored 2+ 1/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5	BTTS NO (Medium)

Fixture cards

National League South

Chelmsford City v Ebbsfleet United

National League South · Mon 09 Nov 19:45 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence WEAK

BTTS lean YES (model Medium) · drivers 9 of 20

Division: cold, 98 of 183 games had 3+

both attacks 3 of 5+

CHELMSFORD CITY home

oldest → newest

scores: 3-3, 1-0, 3-1, 0-2, 2-1

SCORED 2+	● ○ ● ○ ●	**3/5**
LET IN 2+	● ○ ○ ● ○	**2/5**
Game had 3+	● ○ ● ○ ●	3/5
Both scored	● ○ ● ○ ●	3/5
At home, 3+	○ ○ ● ○ ●	2/5

EBBSFLEET UNITED away

oldest → newest

scores: 4-0, 3-1, 0-3, 6-0, 1-0

SCORED 2+	● ● ○ ● ○	**3/5**
LET IN 2+	○ ○ ● ○ ○	**1/5**
Game had 3+	● ● ● ● ○	4/5
Both scored	○ ● ○ ○ ○	1/5
Away, 3+	○ ○ ● ● ●	3/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Chelmsford City scored 2+: 3/5

Ebbsfleet United let in 2+: 1/5

Route: Weak

Chelmsford City: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Ebbsfleet United scored 2+: 3/5

Chelmsford City let in 2+: 2/5

Route: Some support

Ebbsfleet United: clean sheets 3/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 1/5

Why: Chelmsford City 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Ebbsfleet United 4 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Chelmsford City) and 1 of 5 (Ebbsfleet United). Venue: Chelmsford City 2 of 5 home games with 3+, Ebbsfleet United 3 of 5 away.

Risk: Away side kept 3/5 clean sheets

Salisbury v Braintree

National League South · Tue 10 Nov 19:45 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence HIGH

BTTS lean YES (model Medium) · drivers 8 of 20

Division: cold, 98 of 183 games had 3+

SALISBURY home

oldest → newest

scores: 2-0, 2-1, 1-1, 2-0, 2-1

SCORED 2+	● ● ○ ● ●	**4/5**
LET IN 2+	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	**0/5**
Game had 3+	○ ● ○ ○ ●	2/5
Both scored	○ ● ● ○ ●	3/5
At home, 3+	● ○ ● ○ ○	2/5

BRAINTREE away

oldest → newest

scores: 1-2, 0-6, 2-1, 1-0, 1-4

SCORED 2+	○ ○ ● ○ ○	**1/5**
LET IN 2+	● ● ○ ○ ●	**3/5**
Game had 3+	● ● ● ○ ●	4/5
Both scored	● ○ ● ○ ●	3/5
Away, 3+	● ● ● ● ●	5/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Salisbury scored 2+: 4/5

Braintree let in 2+: 3/5

Route: Strong

Salisbury: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 3/5

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Braintree scored 2+: 1/5

Salisbury let in 2+: 0/5

Route: Weak

Braintree: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5

Why: Salisbury 2 of 5 games with 3+ and Braintree 4 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Salisbury) and 3 of 5 (Braintree). Venue: Salisbury 2 of 5 home games with 3+, Braintree 5 of 5 away.

Risk: Braintree let in 2+ in 3 of 5 but scored 2+ only 1 of 5: leaky, not scoring

Plymouth Parkway v Berkhamsted

FA Cup · Mon 09 Nov 19:30 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM

BTTS YES (model High) · drivers 10 of 20

Division: warm, 231 of 365 games had 3+

PLYMOUTH PARKWAY home

oldest → newest

scores: 2-1, 0-2, 1-0, 2-4, 3-1

SCORED 2+		**3/5**
LET IN 2+		**2/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		3/5
At home, 3+		2/5

BERKHAMSTED away

oldest → newest

scores: 0-2, 3-0, 1-3, 1-1, 2-2

SCORED 2+		**2/5**
LET IN 2+		**3/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		3/5
Away, 3+		3/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Plymouth Parkway scored 2+: 3/5

Berkhamsted let in 2+: 3/5

Route: Strong

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Berkhamsted scored 2+: 2/5

Plymouth Parkway let in 2+: 2/5

Route: Some support

Plymouth Parkway: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5 Berkhamsted: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 3/5

Why: Plymouth Parkway 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Berkhamsted 3 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Plymouth Parkway) and 3 of 5 (Berkhamsted). Venue: Plymouth Parkway 2 of 5 home games with 3+, Berkhamsted 3 of 5 away.

Risk: No major warning in the last five

Rejected fixtures, with the model's reason

Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	H sc2+	H let2+	A sc2+	A let2+	Model	Reason
Tue 10 Nov 19:45	National League North	Darlington 1883 v Oxford City	2/5	2/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5
Tue 10 Nov 19:45	National League North	Morecambe v Hereford	3/5	2/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 3/5 and 2/5
Tue 10 Nov 19:45	National League North	Scarborough Athletic v Marine	2/5	4/5	2/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 2/5 and 2/5
Tue 10 Nov 19:45	National League South	Hemel Hempstead Town v Torquay	1/5	4/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5

Data coverage and limitations

• Fixtures analysed: 7. Every count is taken from the stored final score of each match (fixture ID, teams, score); the five scorelines are printed on each card.

• Form sample: each side's last five completed league games this season, cup ties excluded; venue rows use the last five league games at that venue, sample size shown when fewer.

• Not covered by API Sports for 2026-27: Northern Premier, Isthmian and Southern League Division One. 'England V2' is not an API Sports competition and was not included.

• Scored first / conceded after leading: needs match event timelines, not pulled (one call per match, no history). Not shown. First-half goals: available from half-time scores, not yet on the card.

• Injuries and suspensions: the API returned lists for a minority of fixtures this week; nothing is inferred where it returned none. Squad rotation in cup ties is not assessed.

• Opposition strength: each side's opponents' scoring versus the division is held in the analysis file (oq columns) but is not part of the alignment score.

• Competitions in scope with no fixtures in the window: Premier League, Championship, League One, League Two, National League, EFL Cup.

Methodology (V4 lock)

• Selection: gradient-boosted model on each side's last-5 league counts (goals, 3+, 2+ scored, 2+ conceded, clean sheets, failed to score, BTTS), last-3 venue counts and the division's 3+ share. Trained on 2023-24 and 2024-25, validated on 2025-26; cut points from validation deciles. High = top decile; Medium = next two; Weak = bottom quarter of Medium; rejected below.

• Benchmark, season 2026-27 to 2026-11-08 (1824 finished fixtures, Rob's 14 leagues, clean out of sample): 3+ goals in High 84 of 119, Medium 145 of 235, trump card 3 of 4, rejected 812 of 1466. Band counts, not the chance of any one fixture.

• Cup competitions (European and domestic cups), measured separately, season 2026-27 (1606 finished ties): 3+ goals in High 31 of 47, Medium 119 of 197, trump card 2 of 3, rejected 794 of 1359. Cup ties are outside the 14-league benchmark; treat cup selections with that in mind.

• Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ are shown for both sides as evidence. Both attacks 3 of 5+ is highlighted (Selected with it 66%, High 71%) but never required: High fixtures failing a 2-of-5 attacking rule hit 73% on 222 fixtures.

• BTTS (V4.1): YES when the BTTS model is in its High band or the fixture is a trump card; lean YES for the Medium band; no lean for the Low band. BTTS model bands, same fixtures: High 118 of 183, Medium 805 of 1440, Low 121 of 201 had both teams score. A lean, not a pick, and never a veto on Over 2.5.

• V2 and V3 alignment scores were tested (62 to 66% at comparable sizes) and are not used for selection. Full tables in docs/backtest_baseline.md.

• No averages anywhere. Nothing inferred for missing data. Every count comes from stored final scores; the five scorelines are printed on each card.